SYLLABUS - LOGISTICS

Economics 10200

Principles of Macroeconomics

Spring Quarter 2023



Real Median Household Income in the USA.
Source: FRED series MEHOINUSA672N

Prerequisites

No prior familiarity with economics is assumed or required to succeed in this course. I will NOT assume you have any math coursework beyond algebra.

Measured Learning Objectives

Identify components of the macroeconomy and how they relate to each other.

Evaluate economic policy impacts within a simplified economic framework.

Interpret provided macroeconomic data.

Synthesize data and macro-economic theory.

Analyze news events or opinion pieces.

Description

Department Website: By way of theory and public policy applications, this course covers current major domestic and international macroeconomic issues in the U.S. economy, including: the determination of income & output, inflation, unemployment, & economic growth; money, banking, & the Federal Reserve System; federal spending, taxation, & deficits; international trade, exchange rates, and the balance of payments.

Explained: What does economic theory imply about the causes or consequences of USA macroeconomic events and policies? We will discuss how economists measure the macroeconomy (income, output, unemployment, inflation) and how that data relates to our theoretical tools. We trade topic depth for topic range, applying these tools to analyze economic growth, business cycles (recessions and expansions), fiscal policy (government spending, taxation, and deficits), monetary policy (money, banking, and the Federal Reserve System), and international economics (international trade, exchange rates, and the balance of payments). Data and examples will mostly come from the USA economy, but tools can be generally applied to any economy.

Textbooks

I do not assign mandatory homework or reading from any textbook. I will post references to chapters for Mankiw in the Topic Summaries:



(GM) Mankiw. Principles of Macroeconomics (or Principles of Economics) 7th Edition or Later

(TR) Topical Readings: Articles or news stories integrating the course content with current events or context which will be distributed on Canvas or referenced in homework.

While I provide references to Mankiw, you can use keywords from topic summaries to find the corresponding chapter in these books if you prefer:

- (ALL) Acemoglu, Laibson and List. Economics
- (CM) Coppock and Mateer. Principles of Macroeconomics
- (CT) Cowen and Tabarrok. Modern Principles: Macroeconomics
- (DL) Dolan and Lindsey. Introduction to Macroeconomics
- (EC) Eric Chiang. CoreMacroeconomics
- (KW) Krugman and Wells. Macroeconomics
- (MM) Michael Mandel. Economics: The Basics
- (SW) Stevenson and Wolfers. Principles of Macroeconomics
- (TW) Taylor and Weeapana. Principles of Macroeconomics

Econ 10200 SCHEDULE

	CLASS / *Discussion*	Office Hours
MO	1:30-2:50pm (SSRB 122)	4pm-5:30pm (Zoom)
WE	1:30-2:50pm (SSRB 122)	-
TH	-	11am – 1pm (SHFE 428)
FR	*1:30-2:20pm (Registered)*	-
		Dr. G.C. Pieters

preferred salutation: Dr. Pieters//Prof. Pieters she/her

STRUCTURE

In most classes, I will show relevant theory with an application to a real-world situation. Each class meeting introduces a "Quick Response Exercise" (QRE): an economic question to be discussed in groups with analysis ultimately shared with the entire class. Discussion sections revisit mathematical techniques and problems from class and introduce or revisit sample problems closely related to the homework. Discussion section material is selected and designed by the TA.

Homework questions are not a regurgitation of in-class examples. I design the homework assignment to evaluate whether you comprehend the material sufficiently to: (1) understand the question, and (2) complete the economic analysis of that question. The expectation is the same for quiz questions as you must understand the material, not simply memorize definitions or techniques. In addition to class attendance, I assume you will work on the provided practice problems, attend the discussion sections, and visit class hours or post on the Discussion board as needed. In contrast to the class-discussion based QRE and group-based homework, the biweekly quizzes are an individual-level assessment of your knowledge and understanding of the course material.

GRADES CALCULATION

Aggregate Individual Score, $\boldsymbol{AIS_i}$

Your *aggregated individual score* (AIS_i) will not be rounded and is calculated from the combination of the three graded components of this class: Homework, Quick Response Exercises (QRE), and Quizzes.

- Formative Assessment Component (30 points) = Homework Points + QRE Points + Bug Bounty Points
  - The formative assessment component of your grade cannot exceed 30 points. It is the sum of all your homework, QRE, and bug bounty points.
- Test Component (120 points): The sum of your 4 highest Quiz scores.
  - Each quiz is worth 30 points.

$$AIS_i\ (150) = Formative\ Component\ (30) + Quiz\ Component(120)$$

	D	D+	C-	C	C+	B-	B	B+	A-	A
Default										
Fixed (% out of 150)	90 60%	99 66%	102 68%	105 70%	114 76%	117 78%	120 80%	129 86%	132 88%	135 90%
Course Curves (cutoff used if lower than "Default")										
Curve 1: Distribution $\mu = Average\ AIS_i$ $\sigma = Std.\,Dev.$	$\mu - \frac{3}{2}\sigma$	$\mu - \frac{5}{4}\sigma$	$\mu - \sigma$	$\mu - \frac{3}{4}\sigma$	$\mu - \frac{1}{4}\sigma$	μ	$\mu + \frac{1}{4}\sigma$	$\mu + \frac{3}{4}\sigma$	$\mu + \sigma$	$\mu + \frac{5}{4}\sigma$
Curve 2: Share of Grades			C-: AIS_i of the top 75th			B-: Median AIS_i (50th percentile)			A-: AIS_i of the top 25th	

Grade Cutoffs

You will receive the highest letter grade for which your *aggregated individual score*, AIS_i, exceeds the grade cutoff score: $\boldsymbol{AIS_i \geq C_g}$. If the entire class demonstrates mastery of the material (all scores are higher than the cutoff for an A grade), then the entire class will get an A: there is no grade rationing. You are not in a grade competition with other students in this class. I will not certify your understanding as mastery (an A grade) if it is not deserved.

The highest AIS_i needed to **guarantee** a grade is given by the "Fixed" cutoff (If you have an 80%, you will receive no less than a B). I "curve the class" using one of the two curved cutoffs only if the cutoff is lower than the fixed cutoff. I *will never increase the cutoff above the fixed value*.

A "Pass" for a Pass/Fail grade is a D. You must earn a quality (letter) grade of a C- or higher for the course to count towards any track of the Economics major.

Other Grading Notes

• All your grades and graded work will be available on Gradescope. I will not post scores to Canvas because it cannot calculate grades correctly.

• The class average on assessments may vary greatly from assignment to assignment. Individual assessments will not be curved.

• No "Individual-Only" Extra Credit or "Grade Nudges". There will be NO additional grade assistance beyond the curves above. I ignore (and find insulting) all emails that ask for bonus assignments or a "grade nudge". **Everyone has equal opportunity to earn an A grade or to avoid an F**. Grades will not be adjusted to reflect the hours you report working on the course material, your effort, your class participation, your office hours or discussion section attendance, your financial aid status, etc. Your grades reflect only your understanding of the material as evaluated by assessments. Some students may be able to study for 10 minutes and obtain an A, while others can spend an entire week studying and receive an F.

CALENDAR

The following is an outline of all due dates. As the course progresses, the Lecture Topics associated with each class will be updated to reflect what was covered. If the material changes, the date of assessments will **NOT** change, rather the content will be altered.

Week	Date	Summary[§]	Lecture Topic	Due
1	M, March 20	1	Introduction to Macroeconomics & GDP	QRE 1
	W, March 22	2	Cross-Country GDP and Convergence	QRE 2
	F, March 24		*Discussion: Cancelled*	-
2	M, Mar 27	3	Steady State and the Solow Growth Model	QRE 3
	W, Mar 29	4	Growth Accounting and Growth Policies	QRE 4
	F, Mar 31		*Discussion: Homework*	Homework 1
3	M, April 3	5	Real and Nominal GDP	QRE 5
	W, April 5	6	Inflation and Long-Run Aggregate Supply (LRAS)	QRE 6
	F, April 7		*Discussion: Quiz Administered*	**Quiz 1**
4	M, April 10	7	The Allocation of Output: AD & LRAS	QRE 7
	W, April 12	8	Everything is Connected: The CFD & GDP	QRE 8
	F, April 14		*Discussion: Homework*	Homework 2
5	M, April 17	9	What is Aggregate Demand, really?	QRE 9
	W, April 19	10	Perspectives on Trade	QRE 10
	F, April 21		*Discussion: Quiz Administered*	**Quiz 2**
6	M, April 24	11	The (Macro)-Economics of Trade	QRE 11
	W, April 26	12	The Many Measures of Unemployment and Business Cycles	QRE 12
	F, April 28		*Discussion: Homework*	Homework 3
7	M, May 1	13	The AD-AS Model	QRE 13
	W, May 3	14	Economic Schools of Thought	QRE 14
	F, May 5		*Discussion: Quiz Administered*	**Quiz 3**
8	M, May 8	15	Fiscal Policy	QRE 15
	W, May 10	16	Debt, Deficit, Taxation, and Interest Rates	QRE 16
	F, May 12		*Discussion: Homework*	Homework 4
9	M, May 15*	17	Monetary Policy and Interest Rates	QRE 17
	W, May 17	18	Monetary Policy and Inflation	QRE 18
	F, May 19		*Discussion: Quiz Administered*	**Quiz 4**
Finals**	W, May 24		RQ1 is 12:30-1:20pm, and RQ is: 1:40-2:30pm. Location TBD.	**Replacement Quiz 1 & 2**

[§] Corresponding textbook readings and supplementary readings should be determined from the topic summary posted on Canvas. You should also review the material posted to Canvas (the class slides and practice problems).

*This is the last day to Withdraw.

Pass/Fail must be declared by email **no later than the start of the final exam time slot time.

POLICIES AND RESOURCES

Documentation posted on Canvas: Econ 10200 Syllabus Policies - Spring 2023 & Econ 10200 Syllabus Resources - Spring 2023.